PART 1 · PARTNER SELECTION

SELECTED PARTNERS
Hairdresser Hub (6) · Brewed Awakening (1) · Sole Trader Money (7)

REJECTED PARTNER
Best Card Deals UK (3)

I used the benchmark of **£50 per new activated customer** to analyse each partner. I also used my own experience to decide which partner is best. For example, paid traffic is usually lower quality than organic traffic, podcast listeners are easier to convert, and podcast hosts carry more authority with their audience.

Note on the benchmark: the brief says €50, but the UK market and all nine applicants' terms are in £. I treated this as a typo and used **£50** throughout. If euros were intended (about £43), my ranking of the partners would not change.



06 · Hairdresser Hub

6,000 LISTENERS

£600 PER HOST READ

UK salon owners · monthly podcast · card readers, business accounts

AUDIENCE AND PRODUCT FIT
Strong. Salons take in-person payments, so card readers suit them well.

CONTENT QUALITY
Host-read format builds trust. Recent episodes still need checking.

TRAFFIC QUALITY
Small but precise audience. Need downloads and UK share.

VALUE AND TERMS
Fee is paid whatever the result. Negotiate a lower or hybrid fee.



01 · Brewed Awakening

40k MONTHLY VISITS

£40 PER ACTIVATION

Café and coffee blog · weekly posts · card readers, payment links

AUDIENCE AND PRODUCT FIT
Strong café use case, but not every visitor is a UK business owner.

CONTENT QUALITY
Weekly and original, but some top posts are over 2 years old.

TRAFFIC QUALITY
Mostly organic search, which tends to be higher quality.

VALUE AND TERMS
£40 only on activation, so no upfront risk. Good value.



07 · Sole Trader Money

90k MONTHLY VISITS

£45 PER MERCHANT

Freelancer finance blog · monthly updates · invoicing, accounts, payment links

AUDIENCE AND PRODUCT FIT
Excellent. Sole traders need invoicing and payment links.

CONTENT QUALITY
Credible, but some pricing is out of date. Fix before launch.

TRAFFIC QUALITY
Mostly organic, the biggest reach. UK share still to verify.

VALUE AND TERMS
£45 is just under the £50 benchmark. Pay on activations only.

REJECTED · 03

Best Card Deals UK

Strong reach, weak value. It bids on our own brand terms, so we would pay for customers who already searched for SumUp. £3 per click pays for traffic, not activated merchants, and paid search from general consumers converts worse than organic. Market Stall Mums (5) stays as a reserve if its fee comes down.

EFFECTIVE COST PER ACTIVATION AT £3 PER CLICK · BENCHMARK = £50

3% click to activation	**£100**
5% click to activation	**£60**
6% click to activation	**£50 break-even**

Illustrative conversion rates, not forecasts. Brand bidding adds almost no new customers.

PART 2 · ONBOARDING AND ACTIVATION

Goal: launch each partner with agreed terms, tested Impact tracking, accurate content and a named owner.

WEEK 1
Terms agreed, contract signed

WEEK 2
Impact link, tracking, assets

WEEK 3
Approvals and end-to-end test

WEEK 4
Go live, first report

	TO AGREE WITH PARTNER	SUMUP SET-UP BEFORE GO-LIVE	OWNER / TEAM
 **06 Hairdresser Hub**	• Proof of UK salon share, downloads and past sponsor results • One episode: date, host-read script, CTA and #ad disclosure • Fee model: ask for a lower or hybrid fee tied to activations • Reporting: listens at day 7 and 30	• Impact account and unique tracked link • Short vanity URL for the podcast CTA • Script, claims and show notes approved • Link and landing page tested end to end	**Affiliate Manager** terms, schedule **Affiliate Ops** link, tracking **Content / Brand** script, claims **Design / Web** landing page
 **01 Brewed Awakening**	• Page-level traffic, UK share and café-owner share • Placement on high-intent pages, #ad disclosure • £40 per eligible activation, paid on validated activations • Refresh of old posts before we go live	• Impact link and conversion test • SEO picks the pages; Content fixes old prices and claims • Approved copy, images and CTA buttons • Existing pages first; custom page only if tests show a need	**Affiliate Manager** terms **Affiliate Ops** tracking **SEO / Content** pages, copy **Design / Web** visuals
 **07 Sole Trader Money**	• UK traffic share and freelancer intent by page • Correct all out-of-date pricing before launch • £45 sits just under the £50 benchmark • Quarterly review with stop and scale rules	• Impact link and reporting dashboard • Pages and product claims validated • Approved copy, banners and CTAs for invoicing, accounts, payment links • Existing SumUp pages first; bespoke work only if data supports it	**Affiliate Manager** terms, review **Affiliate Ops** reporting **Content / Brand** copy **SEO / Web** fixes **Design** assets

IF A PARTNER ASKS FOR MORE THAN £50

Lead with value, not price: priority support, ready-made assets, co-marketing. Ask for proof of incremental activations first. Any uplift is a tiered bonus above an agreed volume, reviewed quarterly.

SHARED LAUNCH CHECKLIST

- Terms signed off
- Destination and claims accurate
- Activation and attribution defined
- Disclosure approved
- Link tested end to end
- Owner, launch and first review date set

PART 3 · FULL-YEAR PLAN

Hairdresser Hub: a gated 2027 podcast plan for UK salon owners. Each quarter must earn the next.

Q1
JAN–MAR

March: card reader launch

Prove that the audience converts before committing more spend.

PRODUCTS
Card readers (Payments & POS)

CONTENT AND FORMAT
One host-read podcast episode with a real salon payment story and a tracked link in the show notes

METRICS TO TRACK
Listens at day 7 and 30, UK share, clicks, eligible activations, cost per activation

Q2
APR–JUN

May: prepare for summer

Only if Q1 passes. Help salons get ready for the busy season.

PRODUCTS
Card readers, Payment Links (deposits, remote payments)

CONTENT AND FORMAT
Host-read episode plus a short written guide on the partner website

METRICS TO TRACK
Reach, UK audience, click-to-activation rate, valid cost, listener feedback

Q3
JUL–SEP

September: back to business

Reach owners who are catching up on cash flow and admin.

PRODUCTS
Business account and invoicing, only where they fit

CONTENT AND FORMAT
Episode on cash flow and getting paid, with a checklist download

METRICS TO TRACK
Activations, product mix, conversion lag, cost, accuracy of claims

Q4
OCT–DEC

November: Black Friday

Use the busiest trading period to take more payments.

PRODUCTS
Card reader and approved tools. Discounts only if approved

CONTENT AND FORMAT
Seasonal episode, partner email and social mention

METRICS TO TRACK
Day 30 reach, activations, cost, reversals, incremental value

COST PER EPISODE · £600 FIXED

£60
per activation at 10

£30
per activation at 20

Scenarios, not forecasts.

REPORTING

From partner: listens, geography, audience profile
From Impact: clicks, signups, eligible activations, reversals, total cost
Rhythm: day 7 read, day 30 review, quarterly decision

REVIEW RULES

Scale

UK audience verified, tracking works, and activation cost and quality meet the target.

Optimise

Reach good, clicks low: improve the host read and CTA. Clicks good, activations low: check page, offer and tracking.

Pause

Audience cannot be verified, reporting missing, tracking broken, claims wrong or cost above limit.

PART 4 · BIGGEST RISK

The plan must deliver incremental UK customers, not just reach.

THE RISK

Paying for reach, not customers

Listeners, visits or engagement that never become eligible, activated UK small business customers.

01

EARLY WARNING SIGNS

- Low UK audience share
- Reach without tracked clicks
- Clicks that do not become activations
- Traffic that looks too good to be true
- Partner numbers that do not match Impact

02

FIRST ACTION

- **Before launch:** verify audience, agree activation and attribution, test every Impact link
- **After launch:** reconcile partner reports with Impact; check tracking, page and offer before blaming conversion
- Hold new paid commitments until clear

03

FINAL CALL

- **Affiliate Manager / Partnerships Lead** decides: continue, renegotiate or pause
- Affiliate Ops validates tracking
- Finance advises on acquisition cost
- The intern gathers evidence and flags, but does not approve spend

HOW I DECIDE

Scale

when qualified, incremental customers arrive at an acceptable cost

Optimise

when the bottleneck is fixable (page, offer, CTA)

Pause

when audience, tracking, compliance or economics cannot be validated

AI note: AI tools supported the structuring and drafting of this deck. All choices and final wording were reviewed by me.